



SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE

“THE ONLY REASON TO PLAY THE GAME
should be to win. Otherwise one
should sit on the side, watch and learn.”

ANUJ NAUTIYAL,
BNP PARIBAS REAL ESTATE-INDIA, 29

Role Model

Mother Shree Nautiyal who taught him not to abandon hope in the face of trouble and to keep trying.

When Anuj Nautiyal did not clear the entrance exam for the IIMS, he joined Jones Lang LaSalle (JLL), a real estate firm. Unorganised and fragmented when Nautiyal took the plunge, few youngsters regarded real estate as a serious career. But for Nautiyal, MD and CEO of BNP Paribas Real Estate-India, a subsidiary of the European financial services Powerhouse, the turning point came in 2006 when he decided to start his own real estate advisory company, Redwoods Projects. With only Rs 40,000 in his account it was a big gamble. The company started out with two divisions—an advisory arm that provided guidance and another for construction and development. What began as a three-employee company today has 35 people working across three cities. Nautiyal attributes his success to the goodwill among his clients. “Many of them even left JLL to do business with me,” says Nautiyal. A workaholic, he loves exploring new business ideas with friends. Travelling is also a part of this inquisitive nature. He is confident about holding forth in the difficult scenario. “This is the time when people will value quality advice,” he says. For him, adversity equals opportunity.

by Nikita Jain

**“MY CHALLENGE IS TO
CONVERT INTERNET**
users into buyers
by building confidence.”

AVANISH AGARWAL,
JPEARLS.COM, 25



APRASHAKARRAO

His great grandfather traded it in the days of the Nizams. His grandfather ferried it to select homes and even hotel suites. His father sells it at a shop in Secundrabad. But Avnish Agarwal has taken a step further by retailing Hyderabad pearls online. Less than a decade after launching the unique platform, jpearls.com, which began with pearls only, Agarwal, 25, has notched up an impressive annual turnover of Rs 7 crore from a mere Rs 40 lakh in 2003. “When we first thought of a website with a payment gateway in 1999, many wondered what the Internet was,” he recalls. “We offer an unknown option considering that buying jewellery is usually done after seeing and examining the pieces,” explains

Agarwal. For him, the “challenge is to sell it without knowing who is going to buy it”. He believes the Internet users of today are the Internet shoppers of tomorrow. He has shipped orders across India and has been a preferred partner with oil companies and banks including BPCL and ICICI among others. “Online marketing is seemingly simple and a very profitable business. But companies cheat customers to erode confidence which is difficult to build in a virtual market,” he says. Moreover, online customers purchase products that are not expensive to reduce risk. The average ticket

size that Agarwal sells is about Rs 2,500. “This is just the beginning as there is no classified data on the online retail business yet,” says Agarwal.

by Amarnath K. Menon

Role Model

Kishore Biyani who is constantly evolving and implementing innovative retail formats even in the face of an economic downturn.